

Why did God command the Israelites to not sow their fields with mixed seed?

Leviticus 19:19

¶ Ye shall keep my statutes. Thou shalt not let thy cattle gender with a diverse kind: thou shalt not sow thy field with mingled seed: neither shall a garment mingled of linen and woollen come upon thee.

Deuteronomy 22:9

¶ Thou shalt not sow thy vineyard with divers seeds: lest the fruit of thy seed which thou hast sown, and the fruit of thy vineyard, be defiled.

God explains why in **Deu 22:9** “lest the fruit ... be defiled.” But, what does that mean? We need God’s wisdom and guidance to answer our appropriate question which we’re asking the wrong way:

Romans 15:4

For whatsoever things were written aforetime were written for our learning, that we through patience and comfort of the scriptures might have hope.

Romans 6:14-15

¹⁴ For sin shall not have dominion over you: for ye are not under the law, but under grace.

¹⁵ What then? shall we sin, because we are not under the law, but under grace? God forbid.

- The saints of God (**Eph 1:1, 2:19, 4:12**) that are sanctified by Him (**1Cor 6:11,12**) are not under the law nor obligated to keep it (**Acts 15:5,10,20,24,28,29**).

So, if we’re not obligated to keep the law then how could the fruit of the fields be *defiled* if we sow *diverse* seeds in them? To understand this point better refer to the article “Cultivating the fields of God” (<https://cheerful-wmcdannell.wordpress.com/2025/09/17/cultivating-in-the-spirit/>).

A quick summary of that article:

- Those that are saved from the wrath to come are made laborers (sanctified: set aside for the work of God) together with God by God (**John 4:35, 1Cor 3:6-11**) in the “fields” of God.
- The fields of God are human hearts (**John 4:35**).
- The parable of the sower (**Matthew 13:3-8,18-23, Mark 4:3-8, 13-20, Luke 8:5-8, 11-15**) explains to us that the “seed” is the word of God (and much more).
- The sower is the man or woman of God (**Isaiah 55:10,11**) and the seed comes directly from God.
- We’re all given diverse spiritual gifts, divided severally as He wills, for the perfecting of the saints, the work of the ministry, and for the edifying of the body of Christ (**Eph 4:8-12, 1Cor 12:4-11**).
- How do we know which seed goes into which field, when, and how? **Isaiah 28:23-29** (v26).

Learning all that from the word of God: now we can come full circle back to our question, this time with the right perspective: how can we defile the fruit or product of a person’s labors? By sowing *diverse* (different kinds) or *mingled* (mixed) seed in that field. What could we possibly mix with the word of God that could defile the product of a field: the flesh, the world, and the devil.

Therefore, the seed that we sow to people must needs be the pure word of God or “as the oracles of God” (**1Pet 4:11**) (we might say “like the word of God”) or the fruit of that field **will be** defiled. If the seed is good, and it finds good ground, the fruit will be good. But it all starts with the seed.

Matthew 7:18

A good tree cannot bring forth evil fruit, neither can a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit.

Here are some examples:

In this example, the adversary attempts to entice Jesus to do evil (James 1:13,14) by seemingly quoting the word of God. However, if we look carefully at what he said and we compare it to the word of God (John 7:24) we will take notice that he both took away from and added to the word of God (mingled it with his own word/seed). What exactly he changed is the key to determining that, even though he didn't speak exactly the word of God, was what he said "as the oracles of God" (1Pet 4:11) or not?

Luke 4:9-12

⁹ And he brought him to Jerusalem, and set him on a pinnacle of the temple, and said unto him, If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself down from hence:

¹⁰ For it is written, He shall give his angels charge over thee, to keep thee:

¹¹ And in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone.

¹² And Jesus answering said unto him, It is said, Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.

- The adversary makes at least two mistakes here and if he could receive it (John 8:42-47) they could both be corrected simply with the commandment "Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God."
 - Does Psalm 91:11,12 say "at any time"? By adding that phrase, Satan not only masqueraded his deception with a fake "word of God" (Isaiah 14:14) but also completely changed the meaning to imply that it's ok for Jesus to just jump off the pinnacle of the temple anytime He feels like it because the angels will catch Him and keep Him from getting hurt.
 - The adversary begins with the phrase "If thou be the Son of God". That phrase, in and of itself, is tempting God exactly the same way that the children of Israel did in Exodus 17:7.
 - How did God respond to that tempting in the OT and the NT?
 - Exodus 17:7,8 (Amalek is a figure of the flesh)
 - ...Is the LORD among us, or not? Then came Amalek, and fought with Israel in Rephidim.
 - Matthew 12:38-39:
 - Then certain of the scribes and of the Pharisees answered, saying, Master, we would see a sign from thee. But he answered and said unto them, An evil and adulterous generation seeketh after a sign; and there shall no sign be given to it, but the sign of the prophet Jonas:
 - Now, what would happen if we take that mingled seed that Satan tried to sow? We might think "yea, you're right. I can jump off anytime I want" which is corrupt fruit. And, it could bear more corrupt fruit if allowed.

The following example is one of sowing seed that is "as the oracles of God" (1Pet 4:11).

Take the following saying: "The Golden rule" which is generally "Treat others how you want to be treated." That phrase is like the word of God because it conveys the exact same idea a different way:

Matthew 7:12

Therefore all things whatsoever ye would that men should do to you, do ye even so to them: for this is the law and the prophets.

Luke 6:31

And as ye would that men should do to you, do ye also to them likewise.

Therefore, it is not mingled seed, and if it finds good ground it will not bear evil or corrupt fruit.

Matthew 7:15-20

¹⁵ Beware of false prophets, which come to you in sheep's clothing, but inwardly they are ravening wolves. ¹⁶ Ye shall know them by their fruits. Do men gather grapes of thorns, or figs of thistles? ¹⁷ Even so every good tree bringeth forth good fruit; but a corrupt tree bringeth forth evil fruit. ¹⁸ A good tree cannot bring forth evil fruit, neither can a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit. ¹⁹ Every tree that bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire. ²⁰ Wherefore by their fruits ye shall know them.

Luke 6:43-44

⁴³ For a good tree bringeth not forth corrupt fruit; neither doth a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit. ⁴⁴ For every tree is known by his own fruit. For of thorns men do not gather figs, nor of a bramble bush gather they grapes.